

List purposes and schedule for oral hygiene.

A. Purpose

1. Cleanliness of mouth and teeth
2. Prevent mouth odor and infection
3. Prevent dental disease and tooth loss
4. Comfort
5. Pleasant taste
6. Improve taste of food

B. When to perform oral hygiene

1. On awakening
2. After each meal
3. At bed time

C. Special circumstances; when the patient/resident needs more frequent care

1. Unconscious – patient/resident should be side-lying to avoid choking and aspiration
2. Mouth breather
3. O2
4. NG tube or NPO
5. Elevated temperature

Describe procedure of oral hygiene and denture care for a patient/resident needing assistance, and for the unconscious individual.

A. Carry out procedure using standard precautions

1. Contact with mucous membranes
2. Gums may bleed
3. Pathogens may exist in the mouth

B. Examine oral cavity and report findings

1. Dry, cracked, swollen or blistered lips
2. Redness, swelling, sores or white patches in the mouth or on the tongue
3. Redness, swelling or bleeding of gums
4. Loose broken or chipped teeth
5. Patient/resident complaints

C. Dentures

1. Dentures are very costly and fragile
2. Handle with care at all times
3. Any observed damage to dentures

Identify the Nurse Assistant's role and responsibility for patient/resident nail care and foot care.

A. Performed to prevent infection, injury and odors. Guidelines:

1. Nails are easier to clean after soaking in warm, soapy water
2. Cut fingernails with clippers, not scissors (if facility allows)
3. File fingernails with emery board
4. When trimming fingernails, be cautious to prevent damage to tissues
5. Do not trim nails on patient/resident with diabetes or if on medication that affects blood clotting and circulatory problems
6. Do not cut or trim toenails
7. Report unusual conditions to licensed nurse such as redness or tenderness of fingertips, cuticles or toes
8. Follow facility procedure

Identify the Nurse Assistant's role and responsibility for caring for hair or patients/residents.

A. Hair care

1. Part of daily care
2. Important for identity and self-esteem
3. Accommodate patient/resident preferences for style, hair products
4. Shampoo Types
 - a. Shower/tub
 - b. Sink
 - c. Bed
5. Medicinal shampoos are performed per facility policy

B. Report observations

1. Scalp sores
2. Flaking
3. Presence of lice
4. Patches of hair loss
5. Very dry or oily hair
6. How procedure was tolerated

Describe procedure for shaving a patient/resident.

A. Important for feelings of comfort and self-esteem

B. Guidelines

1. Use either electric razor or safety razor (patient/resident choice/facility policy)
2. If using an electric razor use appropriate safety precautions for electrical equipment
3. Safety razors can cause nicks or cuts; use standard precautions to prevent contact with blood